

FOR CONG AND COUNTRY
Congress Seva Dal members hoist the flag before walking for the day at Kala Bakra

joins. They are equipped with a sofa, table, freezer, and an attached bathroom

- The second kind of containers have a double bed and an attached bathroom. Marked blue, they are meant for use by top leaders such as Digvijaya Singh and Jairam Ramesh
- The third type of container has four beds but no attached bathroom. Marked green, such containers are meant for senior state leaders
- The remaining containers have 8 and 12 beds and no attached toilet. Marked orange, these are meant for the use of the rest of the yatris
- The containers halt at different locations every day. An area of two acres is needed to park them and erect a makeshift dining hall
- Breakfast and dinner for 300 people is prepared daily and served
- Around 40,000 veg meals are prepared for lunch every day
- Temporary camps are set up separately during the day for the permanent yatris and common people to have lunch in and rest
- 75,000-100,000 packaged water bottles—branded especially for BJY—are used daily
- Each container has a load capacity of 20-amp electricity. Four gensets of 125 KVA each and two of 65 KVA each provide electricity

THE PLANNERS



DIGVIJAYA SINGH, 75
The Rajya Sabha member and head of the central planning committee has been leading the walk on most days



K.B. BYJU, 55
Former SPG man and Rahul's close confidant, he coordinates all the logistics related to the yatra with the state units

THE MESSENGERS



JAIRAM RAMESH, 68
The Rajya Sabha MP and AICC General Secretary oversees all communication on traditional and social media



SUPRIYA SHRINATE, 45
The AICC chairperson of Social Media and Digital Platforms leads the 60-strong team running the social media campaign



SRIVATSA Y.B., 39
The former MNC executive heads Rahul Gandhi's social media team of nearly 10 members



TEEN BANDAR
The Mumbai-based digital outreach company is helping the Congress social media team during the Bharat Jodo Yatra

beard and all, appeared more like a messiah than the angry young man of yore. He still doesn't mince words when speaking out against the Modi government, but the tone is of a *tapasvi*, as he calls himself, someone who is willing to make extreme sacrifices for the greater good of society. "Rahul Gandhi now appears a more mature and confident political leader," says Sudha Pai, a retired professor of Political Science at the Centre for Political Studies (CPS) in Delhi's Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU). "Many of his speeches portray a certain understanding of what the country needs. Earlier, it was all about attacking the BJP." Zoya Hasan, professor emeritus at JNU, also believes that the BJY has given people a chance to see the real Rahul Gandhi, someone who is prepared to slog it out, someone who believes passionately in the values that India was founded on and not the caricature of a Pappu that the BJP and the media have created.